

NetFrame

working title
Version 0.5

These rules set out a method of handling movement and combat between Mobile Suits. The game is played across 6 turns, after which the team with the most victory points wins. Each player brings the same number of Frames, each with their own deck. A good default number is 3 per player, although with teams 2 each can be smoother. With many players teams are recommended over battle royale, though the rules support either playstyle. All frames a player brings should be from the same faction.

Victory Points

Victory points are obtained in two key ways:

- 1 point per enemy frame defeated
- Points equal to the defender score for each objective they successfully defended
- Points equal to the attacker score for each objective they successfully attacked

The battlefield

Terrain blocks movement and line of sight. Terrain that can be stood upon is classified as being on different levels.

Terrain Cards

It is recommended for each player to bring a terrain deck of 15 cards, of which between 2 and 3 should be objectives. These cards are shuffled, dealt and construct the battlefield. On the card is a grid, on which the frames move and ranges are reckoned. The border of the tiles indicate the elevation

black	ground level
dark blue	level 1
blue	level 2
light blue	elevation 3
red	impassible

Tiles that contain obstacles have a yellow dashing on their border. Tiles that indicated objectives are highlighted in green, tiles that need a token placed on them have hatching.

Movement on these tiles is lateral and diagonal. The 8 tiles surrounding any one tile are all adjacent to it (so would count for melee attacks). Ranges are considered the same way (so you can consider the maximum range a square centered on the frame with sides of length twice the range).

Terrain cards



Explanation of each element of a terrain card

Prebuilt Terrain

If you prefer, instead of using the terrain cards you can use whatever terrain setup you have at your gaming table. Players should quickly agree at the start of the game what level each piece of terrain is, but as a quick rule of thumb, moving up one frame's height is roughly one level. The level indicates how much movement it takes to climb onto the terrain, and what can see what. In this case, for objectives you can either draw objective cards from the deck and place appropriate markers and tokens at a location of your choosing, or use pre agreed objectives, and the objectives on the cards can be used as reference. In this case, distances are measured with a tape measure and a fixed base unit should be established based on the scale of the miniatures. Deployment zones are 10 units away from the midline.

Line of sight

For a frame to be selected as a target of an attack, there must be a direct (i.e. no steps moving in an opposite direction to a previous step), unbroken (so it can't pass through an obstruction) and symmetric (so the distribution of diagonal and lateral steps should be even across the route) path of steps less than or equal to the range between the edge of the attacking frame

and the target.

The following count as an obstruction:

- Other Frames
- Impassible terrain
- Terrain at a higher level than the attacker
- Obstacles adjacent to the target
- Terrain at a higher elevation than the target next to the target

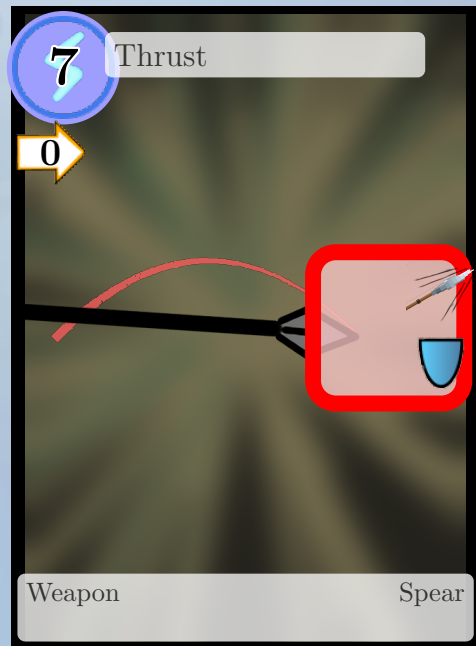
Setup

If using the terrain decks, each player deals out 12 of their terrain cards from their terrain deck landscape in 3 rows of (nframes + 2) to make a grid. (for 2 players with 3 frames each that makes a 6x5 grid). If a player deals out as many or more objective cards than the number of frames they bring, or deals an objective in their deployment zone, the most recently revealed objective is put to the bottom and a new card dealt in its place. Any relevant tokens are placed on them. All objectives on these terrain cards are valid for this battle - you are defending any objectives that are on your teams terrain cards.

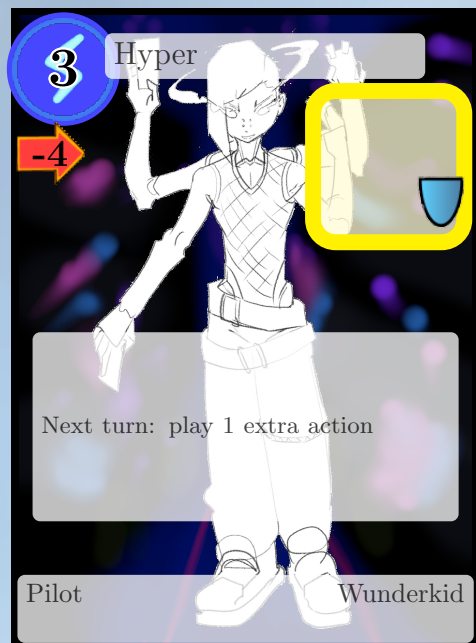
Each player takes it in turns to put one of their frames in their deployment zone (The row of terrain cards nearest them if using, else anywhere more than 12 from the center line). After all frames are deployed this way, shuffle the decks, and the player who deployed first receives the priority marker.

Card anatomy

Initiative: 	Marks when the card will resolve. Higher numbers resolve before lower numbers
Movement: 	How much to add (or subtract if its negative) to the movement for the action with this card
Attack marks: 	How much damage to deal at this location if this attack hits (symbol indicates damage type)
Attack range: 	Range of ranged attack
Block mark: 	Region that this card can block for
Single use mark: 	Indicates that the card is set aside and not shuffled back in after use.
Ability text:	Effects that happen when this card is played or resolved.
Type info: (bottom)	What type of card it is, and categorisation information. Used for deckbuilding.



A Weapon Card



A Pilot Card

The turn

On each turn of the game there are 3 phases: planning, action and cleanup.

Planning

in the planning phase, simultaneously for each frame 5 cards are drawn from it's deck, and from those 2 are chosen and placed facedown. The rest of the cards are placed on the bottom of the deck. each deck has one additional marked card in it - if that card would be drawn, instead the deck is shuffled.

Echos of the fallen

If a frame has been defeated, at the end of the planning phase the player can reveal the top card of that frame's deck and put it sideways with the actions of a surviving frame. That card can also be used to block attacks this turn.

Status update

At the end of the planning phase, one status token of each type is removed from each frame.

Action

At the start of the action phase all the face down cards are turned face up.

Cards are resolved in order of the initiative value, starting with the highest. In the event of a tie, players take it in turns to choose one card at the current initiative to resolve, starting with the player with the priority marker and moving clockwise.

Card resolution consists of 3 steps: movement, effect, and attack, resolved in that order.

Pre-combat Movement

The frame can move up to their base movement plus the movement modifier on the card currently being resolved steps in any direction. The frame can move either before or after attacking.

Movement penalties

It takes 1 movement to move up per level difference, and you cannot stop halfway up. It costs 1 movement to move down any number of levels. Obsacles can be crossed at a -1mv penalty, but cannot be stopped inside.

Effect

After movement is done, any effect on the card is applied. Effects are applied in printed order. Debuffs and similar are marked on the affected frames. If a duration is not specified, a buff/debuff applies until the end of the next turn

Attack

If the card has any attack listed, one target frame within any of the ranges may be chosen. For attacks without a range value, the target must be adjacent, and this attack is a melee attack. They are then the defender for this attack. If the defender has a block on their remaining cards in the same zone as any of the attacks that are in range, they must choose one of those cards to block. The attack fails and that blocking card is discarded (if its initiative hasn't been reached yet it never happens). Otherwise the attack succeeds, and the defender takes one damage per attack mark in the corresponding zone (high/mid/low). After finishing the attack the card resolution ends, and the card remains on the field to be used to block. (It can be helpful to turn it sideways to indicate that its been resolved)

Melee between levels

If the attack is a melee attack and the defender is at a different elevation to the attacker, the attacks are moved up one bracket per difference in elevation. Any attacks that are moved higher than High or lower than Low are considered out of range.

So for example, Frame A at elevation 1 attacks Frame B at elevation 3 with cleave, which has  high and  mid. The attacker is 2 levels lower than the defender, so the attacks are moved 2 stages down. The  high end up  low, and the  mid are out of range. Conversely if Frame C at elevation 2 were to attack Frame A with Thrust ( mid), it would be moved one stage up, resulting in  high.

Ranged attacks are not affected by elevation in this way.

Damage

Each frame can endure a number of hits on each zone indicated on the character card (default 4) after which they are destroyed. Destroyed frame are removed from the battlefield and can no longer contribute to the fight. Additionally any frame that has endured 2 or more damage in any location faces the following penalty corresponding to the location:

- High -1 initiative (reduce initiative on all actions by 1)
- Mid -1 cards (draw one less card to choose actions from)
- Low -1 movement (reduce base movement by 1)

Post-combat Movement

If the frame did not move before applying effects and attacking it may move after finishing the attack.

Cleanup

All remaining cards on the field are discarded. Cards with the single use mark are set aside underneath the

frame card, while all other cards that were discarded are put to the bottom of their respective decks. The priority marker then moves one step anticlockwise.

Status

Various cards apply certain status effects to frames. These status effects are marked with a counter added to the frame. As long as the frame has any amount of the status marker on it, the frame's stats are modified according to the status. The modification amount is the same regardless of the quantity of status counters.

	Debuff	Buff
Status:	Stunned  (-2 init)	Stimmed  (+2 init,
	Dazed  (-2 card)	Lucid  (+2 cards)
	Slowed  (-2 movement)	Boosted  (+2 mv)

Status annihilation

If a frame would receives the opposite status to the status it already has, instead remove that many of the counters it already has before applying the difference.

Status application

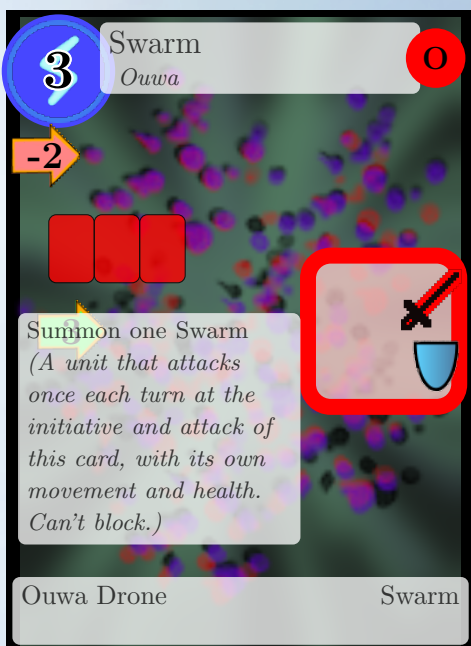
The number of status counters on the frame indicate the duration of the effect. Each turn, after the planning phase finishes one of each status counter is removed.

Tokens

Terrain and various card effects create tokens. These can normally be indicated by anything you have around, coins, dice, whatever, as long as it is clear to everyone what it is. Dedicated token pieces are also manufactured for players who wish to use them.

Drones

Some attacks summon drones TODO!



Deck Construction

Each mobile suit must have a deck. To construct a deck, you first choose the frame. That frame has a stats card with the following information:



- Base movement
- Faction
- Armor values at each location
- Deck size 
- Weapon count 
- Booster count 
- Frame ability (if any)

The frame's deck must have exactly the numnber of cards in its deck size count in it. To build the deck, you can have:

- Max 4 pilot cards, all from the same pilot, no duplicates
- Max X booster cards, where X is the frame's booster count (duplicates allowed)
- Up to N weapons where N is the frame's weapon count. Each weapon is a set of 4 attack cards. For each weapon slot you can include up to 1 of each card in that weapon.
- 1 of each of the generic cards

If any card has a faction logo on it, it can only be in a deck for a frame of that faction.

Example Frame deck for RipperSmasher (20 cards, 3 weapons, 2 boosters):

count	type	group	cards
3	pilot	bruiser	Relentless Assault, Intimidate, Net Strength
2	booster		Accelerate, Accelerate
4	weapon	Chainsaw	Rip, Grind, Tear, Disembowel
4	weapon	Cannon	Fullbore, Airburst, Cannon, Pummel
4	weapon	Cannon	Fullbore, Airburst, Cannon, Pummel
3	Generic		Block, Block, Dodge

Ability Keywords

On Hit:	The ability text after the colon only applies if the attack hits (that is, is not blocked)
Guard Break	This attack deals damage equal to its damage count minus the number of blocks consumed by it
Committed Feint	this attack is consumed after it resolves if this attack is not blocked, it deals no damage
on strike: (X)	if this attack hits (is not blocked), then X happens
Flying	This frame does not spend movement to cross obstacles or move between floors. Terrain of less than 1 level height does not block LoS to or from this frame.
Shield (X)	When a card with shield (X) resolves, or a frame with shield (X) starts, put X shield counters on the frame card. A frame can only have 1 more shield than it's shield value. The next time the frame would take any amount of damage, instead remove one shield counter from the frame.
Deathstrike	When this frame would be destroyed, they continue to fight until the end of the next turn, after which they are removed from play if they are still dead (they can be repaired)

Glossary